DANIEL AHMADIZADEH

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Entrepreneurship educator, founder coach, and two-time CEO of Y Combinator-backed companies. Creator of Start With One, a framework for solving a real problem for one person through customer discovery and practical experimentation.

EDUCATION

Columbia Business School - Master of Business Administration (MBA)
Stony Brook University - Bachelor's degree, Business Management

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Columbia University 2023-Present
Course Instructor, Entrepreneurship & Innovation | Pre-College Programs
• Teach customer discovery, prototyping, go-to-market strategy, and fundraising; guide students from a real customer problem to a final demo.

Stanford University 2024-Present
Course Instructor, Innovation & Entrepreneurship | Pre-Collegiate Studies
• Lead summer courses on idea validation, customer discovery, and prototype development, culminating in a student Demo Day.

D.Y. Patil Vidyapeeth 2024-Present
Professor, Startup & New Venture Management | MBA Program
• Teach a semester-long entrepreneurship course for 200+ MBA students, covering business models, minimum viable products, go-to-market strategy, and fundraising.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP & FOUNDER COACHING

Crustdata (YC F24) 2025-Present
Growth & Go-to-Market
• Helped grow annual recurring revenue from **$600K to $14M**; lead growth initiatives and work with customers adopting real-time people and company data APIs.

Marathon Laps 2021-Present
Founder Coach & Fractional Operator
• Coach early-stage founders, including YC-backed startups, on customer discovery, idea validation, founder-led sales, and accelerator interview preparation.

PersistIQ (YC S14) 2019-2021
Chief Executive Officer (previously General Manager)
• Led a Y Combinator-backed sales engagement software company, subsequently acquired by Wishpond Technologies.

Riley Corporation (YC W17) 2014-2019
Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer
• Built a real estate lead engagement and CRM business; raised **$3.1M in seed funding** from investors including Y Combinator, Fuel Capital, and Social Capital.

SELECTED WORKSHOPS & AFFILIATIONS

South Park Commons: Member, 2021-2024.
TED: Resident, 2016.
KLAK - Icelandic Startups: entrepreneurship workshops and founder mentorship.